

Print Content (Canvaに流す完成原稿・英語)

Page 1 — Cover

Hidden Japan

Hokuriku & Toyama Trip Planner

The Japan Tourists Skip — Just 30 Minutes from Kanazawa

Seafood ・ Craft Towns ・ Mountains ・ No Crowds

[Add your trip dates here]

Page 2 — Why Hokuriku?

Most first-time visitors do Tokyo and Kyoto and never look further. Hokuriku — the region facing the Sea of Japan — is the quieter Japan: a craft town casting bronze the same way for 400 years, a fishing port famous for winter yellowtail, mountain villages with thatched roofs, and one of the world's great alpine crossings.

Why it works:

- Kanazawa is a Shinkansen hub; Toyama and Takaoka are ~20-40 minutes away.
- Far fewer crowds than the golden route.
- Rare regional food you won't find elsewhere.
- Easy to combine with a standard Tokyo/Kyoto trip.

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Page 4 — 5-Day Itinerary at a Glance

Day	Base	Theme	Highlights
1	Kanazawa	Arrival & old town	Gardens, geisha & samurai districts, market
2	Kanazawa → Toyama/Takaoka	Crafts & bronze	Great Buddha, foundry town, canal views
3	Himi	Bay & seafood	Fishing port, white shrimp, mountain-and-sea view
4	Gokayama	Mountain villages	Thatched-roof hamlets, folk crafts
5	Tateyama-Kurobe	Alpine crossing	Snow walls, dam, peaks, then departure

Page 5 — Day 1: Kanazawa

Time	Plan
Morning	Arrive by Shinkansen; drop bags near the station
Midday	Strolling garden famous as one of Japan's finest
Afternoon	Samurai and geisha districts; gold-leaf crafts
Evening	Seafood dinner near the old market

Daily plan:

- ☒ Breakfast
- ☒ Morning activity
- ☒ Lunch
- ☒ Afternoon activity
- ☒ Dinner
- ☒ Notes / photos to remember

Page 6 — Day 2: Toyama & Takaoka

Time	Plan
Morning	Short train to Takaoka; visit the Great Buddha
Midday	Historic bronze-casting district and craft workshops
Afternoon	Canal townscape; tram ride into Toyama city
Evening	Local izakaya; try regional sake

Daily plan:

- ☒ Breakfast
- ☒ Morning activity
- ☒ Lunch
- ☒ Afternoon activity
- ☒ Dinner
- ☒ Notes / photos to remember

Page 7 — Day 3: Himi & Toyama Bay

Time	Plan
Morning	Train to the Himi fishing port
Midday	Fresh seafood lunch (white shrimp, seasonal catch)
Afternoon	Seaside walk; on clear days, mountains rise across the bay
Evening	Return to base; relaxed evening

Daily plan:

- ☒ Breakfast
- ☒ Morning activity
- ☒ Lunch
- ☒ Afternoon activity
- ☒ Dinner
- ☒ Notes / photos to remember

Page 8 — Day 4: Gokayama Mountain Villages

Time	Plan
Morning	Bus into the mountains to thatched-roof hamlets
Midday	Village lunch; folk-craft paper-making
Afternoon	Quiet walking trails and viewpoints
Evening	Back to base; pack for the alpine day

Daily plan:

- ☒ Breakfast
- ☒ Morning activity
- ☒ Lunch
- ☒ Afternoon activity
- ☒ Dinner
- ☒ Notes / photos to remember

Page 9 — Day 5: Tateyama–Kurobe Alpine Route & Departure

Time	Plan
Morning	Start the alpine crossing early (cable car, bus, ropeway)
Midday	Snow corridor (spring), dam, and high-mountain views
Afternoon	Descend; collect luggage
Evening	Shinkansen onward or to your next base

Daily plan:

- ☒ Breakfast
- ☒ Alpine crossing
- ☒ Lunch
- ☒ Descent / travel
- ☒ Head to station

Note: The Alpine Route is seasonal and closed in winter — check the latest opening dates and book legs in advance.

Page 10 — Kanazawa

Highlight	Why go
Famous strolling garden	Among Japan's most celebrated gardens
Samurai district	Preserved earthen-wall streets
Geisha district	Wooden teahouse architecture
Gold-leaf crafts	Local specialty; workshops and sweets
Seafood market	Sea-of-Japan catch, casual eateries

Tip: A clean, compact city — easy to cover key sights in a day on foot and by bus.

Page 11 — Toyama & Takaoka

Highlight	Why go
Great Buddha (Takaoka)	One of Japan’s notable large bronze Buddhas
Bronze-casting district	400-year metal-craft tradition, working workshops
Canal townscape	Photogenic waterside streets
City trams (Toyama)	Easy, scenic local transport
Glass art (Toyama)	Modern craft scene

Tip: Takaoka’s foundry heritage makes for unique, locally made souvenirs.

Page 12 — Himi & Toyama Bay Food

Toyama Bay is unusually deep, which is why its seafood is so prized.

Must-try:

- ☒ White shrimp (shiro-ebi) — sweet, delicate, a Toyama specialty
- ☒ Winter yellowtail (kan-buri) — rich cold-season fish
- ☒ Firefly squid (hotaru-ika) — spring delicacy
- ☒ Fresh sashimi rice bowls
- ☒ Local kelp-cured dishes

When	What's in season
Spring	Firefly squid
Summer	White shrimp peak
Autumn	Mixed catch
Winter	Yellowtail

Note: Seafood availability and prices are seasonal — check the latest before planning a food-focused trip.

Page 13 — Gokayama & Tateyama-Kurobe

Gokayama:

- Thatched-roof (gassho-zukuri) mountain villages
- Traditional washi paper-making
- Quiet, less-visited than the better-known village nearby

Tateyama-Kurobe Alpine Route:

- A multi-leg crossing of the Northern Japan Alps
- Cable cars, ropeway, and high-altitude buses
- Spring snow corridor; large dam; alpine panoramas
- Seasonal — confirm opening dates and reserve in advance

Page 14 — Getting Around: Shinkansen / IC / Passes / Alpine Route

Option	What it is	Good for
Shinkansen	High-speed train	Reaching Kanazawa / Toyama
Local & regional trains	Frequent connections	Hopping between towns
IC card	Rechargeable tap card	Trains, trams, buses, shops
City trams	Local lines	Toyama / Takaoka sightseeing
Regional passes	Area unlimited-ride passes	Multi-stop itineraries
Alpine Route tickets	Multi-leg crossing pass	Tateyama-Kurobe day

Plan ahead:

- Get an IC card on arrival.
- A regional pass can pay off across several days — compare vs. single fares.
- Book Alpine Route legs early in peak season; it is closed in winter.
- Schedules, fares, and pass coverage change — check the latest official info.

Page 15 — Avoid-the-Crowds Tips

- ☒ Start gardens and temples at opening time (08:00-09:00)
- ☒ Visit craft towns on weekdays
- ☒ Do the Alpine Route on the earliest legs of the day
- ☒ Base in Kanazawa and day-trip outward to dodge tour-bus timing
- ☒ Eat lunch slightly early (11:30) at popular seafood spots
- ☒ Save the famous village for the shoulder season; choose the quieter hamlets
- ☒ Travel mid-week between cities when possible

Page 16 — Budget Tracker

Category	Planned	Actual
Flights / Shinkansen		
Accommodation		
Local transport / passes		
Alpine Route tickets		
Food & drinks		
Attractions / workshops		
Shopping / souvenirs		
Buffer / emergencies		
TOTAL		

Tip: Carry cash for rural towns and small eateries. Costs vary by season — check the latest before locking in.

Page 17 — Packing Checklist

Essentials:

- ☒ Passport & travel insurance
- ☒ IC card / regional pass
- ☒ Phone, charger, power bank
- ☒ Travel adapter
- ☒ Cash + card

For mountains & bay:

- ☒ Warm layers (cold even in spring at altitude)
- ☒ Waterproof jacket
- ☒ Comfortable walking shoes
- ☒ Sunglasses & sunscreen (snow glare)
- ☒ Small daypack

Extras:

- ☒ Reusable water bottle
- ☒ Hand towel / tissues
- ☒ Offline translation pack
- ☒ Motion-sickness remedy (mountain buses)

Page 18 — Useful Japanese Phrases

English	Japanese	Reading
Hello	こんにちは	Konnichiwa
Thank you	ありがとう	Arigatou
Excuse me / sorry	すみません	Sumimasen
Yes / No	はい / いいえ	Hai / Iie
How much is it?	いくらですか	Ikura desu ka
Where is...?	...はどこですか	...wa doko desu ka
One ticket, please	切符を一枚ください	Kippu o ichimai kudasai
Is it open today?	今日は開いていますか	Kyou wa aite imasu ka
Delicious!	おいしい	Oishii
Do you speak English?	英語を話せますか	Eigo o hanasemasu ka

Page 19 — Notes

Memories to keep:

- ☒ Best meal in Toyama Bay
- ☒ Favorite craft town moment
- ☒ Best mountain view
- ☒ Something tourists are missing